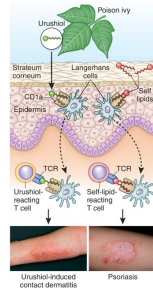


# Urushiol-Induced Allergy



## What is Urushiol?

Poison ivy, poison oak, and poison sumac release an oil called urushiol from its broken leaves, stems or roots. When this oil gets on the skin an allergic reaction, referred to as contact dermatitis (an itchy rash) occurs on the skin.



## OTC options for at home treatment.

Over-the-counter treatments for symptoms of poison ivy are calamine (a combination of zinc oxide, ferric oxide, mixed with phenol and calcium hydroxide), baking soda, and colloidal oatmeal; aluminum acetate; hydrocortisone and oral diphenhydramine. It is not advised to apply topical antihistamines for example topical diphenhydramine to the rash due to its potential to worsen the symptoms.



## How to Identify Poison Ivy rash?

Contact dermatitis causes the skin to become itchy, blistered, dry and cracked. Lighter skin can become red, and darker skin can become dark brown, purple or grey. This reaction usually occurs within a few hours or days of exposure to Urushiol oil.



## When to seek medical care?

You may need prescription medication for a rash that's severe or widespread, especially if it's on your face or genitals. Seek emergency medical attention if:

You inhaled the smoke from burning poison ivy and are having difficulty breathing.

The reaction is severe or widespread.

Your skin continues to swell.

Blisters are oozing pus.

You develop a fever greater than 100 F (37.8 C).

The rash doesn't get better within a few weeks.

## First action to take upon contact!

Wash your skin right away if you come into contact with poison urushiol oil. Washing off the oil may reduce your chances of getting a poison ivy rash. You can treat mild cases of poison ivy rash at home with soothing lotions and cool baths.



## Links for more Information

<https://www.cdc.gov/niosh/topics/plants/exposure.html>

<https://www.mayoclinic.org/diseases-conditions/poison-ivy/symptoms-causes/syc-20376485>

<https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC7733371/>